Prodigy Anesthesia Quick Review

Hysteroscopy

What is a hysteroscopy?	A hysteroscopy is a surgical procedure that allows the endometrial cavity to be examined. It is often used to diagnose the reason for abnormal uterine bleeding. Often, causes of bleeding such as myomas and polyps can be removed through the hysteroscope. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 807.*
How is a hysteroscopy performed?	The patient is anesthetized and placed in the lithotomy position. A speculum is inserted into the vaginal canal, a tenaculum is attached to the cervix, and the hysteroscope is inserted when the cervix is sufficiently dilated. A distention media is used to expand the uterus for better visualization of the uterine structures. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 807-808.*
What methods of anesthesia may be used for hysteroscopy?	Local, regional, or general anesthesia is acceptable for diagnostic hysteroscopies. If the procedure is an operative hysteroscopy, then general anesthesia is usually performed. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 807.*
What is the risk of performing hysteroscopy under a neuraxial anesthetic?	The patient population that typically presents for a hysteroscopy (young females) is at particular risk for developing a postdural puncture headache. If a spinal anesthetic is to be used, a pencil-point needle is recommend to decrease the risk of PDPH. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 809.*
What sensory level is sufficient for a hysteroscopy if a neuraxial anesthetic is employed?	T10 *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 809.*
What distention media are used during a hysteroscopy?	Normal saline, sorbitol/mannitol 3%, and mannitol 5% solutions are commonly used distention media with normal saline being the most common. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 808.*

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What are the risks associated with using a solution such as mannitol or normal saline as the distention media for a hysteroscopy?	Normal saline, sorbitol/mannitol 3%, and mannitol 5% solutions are all commonly used distention media (normal saline is the most common). The absorption of 500 mL of a hypertonic solution or 1L of an isotonic solution should prompt consideration of cessation of the procedure to avoid fluid volume overload. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 808.*
What nerves are at risk for damage in a patient undergoing a hysteroscopy and why?	Excessive flexion of the hip joint can cause damage to the femoral and lateral femoral cutaneous nerves. The obturator and saphenous nerves are also susceptible to injury resulting from lithotomy position. The patient's hands should be placed on armboards or wrapped in padding if tucked to prevent injury to the fingers when raising the leg section of the bed. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 810.*

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